APTITUDE FOR INTERVIEWS

A Complete Preparation Guide for Placements, GATE, CAT & Competitive Exams

Why Aptitude Matters

Most IT companies conduct aptitude tests online. All are 100% objective type. The importance varies based on the company tier:

Company Tier	Aptitude Emphasis
Top-tier (Google, Meta)	May or may not conduct aptitude tests
Excellent (Adobe, Goldman Sachs)	Sometimes include aptitude
Above-average (7–12 LPA)	Frequently conduct aptitude tests
Average (TCS, Infosys, Accenture)	Always include as a key screening round

Strategy & Preparation Plan

1. Understand the Test Format

- Research the specific aptitude test format (numerical, verbal, logical, etc.)
- Gather related practice materials: books, sample papers, websites

2. Assess Your Current Level

- Take a diagnostic practice test
- Analyze results and focus on weak areas

3. Numerical Aptitude

- Revise arithmetic, percentages, ratios, and data interpretation
- Practice questions and analyze your mistakes

4. Verbal Reasoning

- Build vocabulary and grammar
- Practice reading comprehension to improve accuracy and speed

5. Logical Reasoning

- Learn common question patterns: puzzles, sequences, diagrams
- Practice a variety of logical reasoning exercises

6. Full-Length Practice Tests

- Simulate test conditions with full-length timed tests
- Analyze results, learn from mistakes, and reinforce strengths

7. Final Revision & Mindset

- Go over key notes, formulas, and shortcuts
- Practice relaxation and breathing techniques to manage test anxiety
- Stay calm, focused, and get adequate rest before the actual test

Key Points to Keep in Mind

Tips for Success
• Focus on learning short tricks and increasing speed
• Practice daily — even 30–60 mins a day makes a big difference over time
• Focus on accuracy first, then improve speed with mock tests
• Maintain a notebook of formulas, shortcuts, and mistake logs
• Start with comfortable topics to build confidence, then tackle harder ones
• Use previous year placement papers and mock tests to understand real exam patterns
• Solve questions within a set time to simulate actual exam pressure
• Watch video explanations when stuck — visual learning helps clarify concepts faster
• Always review solutions of questions you got wrong — that is where you learn the most

Topic Overview

Section	Topics Covered
Quantitative Aptitude	1. Percentage 2. Average 3. Age 4. Ratio & Proportion 5. Mixture & Allegations 6. Profit & Loss 7. Simple & Compound Interest 8. Speed, Distance & Time (Boats, Trains) 9. Time and Work 10. Permutation & Combination 11. Probability 12. Number System 13. Data Interpretation (Charts & Tables)

Logical Reasoning	1. Blood Relation 2. Syllogism 3. Direction Sense 4. Coding-Decoding 5. Alphanumeric Series 6. Data Sufficiency 7. Reasoning Analogy 8. Puzzle-based Questions 9. Seating Arrangement 10. Logical Deduction
Verbal Ability	1. Articles 2. Preposition 3. Adjectives 4. Sentence Rearrangement 5. Comprehension 6. Synonyms & Antonyms 7. Spotting Errors
General Aptitude	1. Reflection (Water & Mirror) 2. Clocks & Calendars 3. Number Series 4. Letter Series 5. Word Problems 6. Decision Making 7. Critical Reasoning

Best YouTube Playlists

- Aptitude Playlist (especially for placements)
- GATE Aptitude Playlist (concepts apply to placements too)

Recommended Guides & Websites

- GeeksForGeeks — Aptitude for Placements
- GitHub — Placement Preparation (Aptitude)
- Let's Code — Aptitude Roadmap
- Naukri Code360 — Aptitude Preparation Path
- Naukri Code360 — Top 150 Interview Puzzles

25-Day Study Plan

A structured breakdown to cover all aptitude topics systematically before your placement tests.

Duration	Focus Area	Topics to Cover
Days 1–10	**Quantitative Aptitude**	1. Time and Work 2. Time, Speed and Distance 3. Permutations and Combinations 4. Percentage 5. Numbers 6. Average 7. Profit and Loss 8. Ratio and Proportion 9. Mixtures & Allegations 10. Probability
Days 11–20	**Logical Reasoning**	1. Arrangements & Puzzles 2. Syllogisms 3. Coding-Decoding 4. Number Series 5. Cryptarithmetic 6. Clocks and Calendar 7. Data Sufficiency 8. Most Logical Choice 9. Logical Deduction
Days 21–25	**Verbal Ability + Puzzles**	1. Spotting Errors 2. Synonyms & Antonyms 3. Completing Statements 4. Sentence Improvement & Correction 5. Comprehension 6. Paragraph Formation 7. Verbal Analogies 8. Idioms and Phrases 9. Practice Puzzles (similar type)

Resources for the First 25 Days

Practice Websites

- GeeksForGeeks — General Syllabus + Practice Modules
- IndiaBix — Best Resource to Practice Everything
- PrepInsta — Quantitative Aptitude Practice

Video Lectures

Finish at least one full aptitude playlist from the first 3 channels:

Recommended YouTube Channels
• 1. Aptitude Academy — Core aptitude concepts and shortcuts
• 2. CareerRide — Placement-focused aptitude walkthroughs
• 3. FreshersWorld — Campus placement preparation videos
• 4. Verbal Ability Playlist — Focused verbal and grammar practice

Final Advice

An aptitude test is easy when you are well-prepared. *Start early, practice consistently, and stay confident!*

ALL THE BEST!

Note: This document is a reflection of a personal journey, experiences from colleagues, friends, and many online resources (Google, YouTube, Reddit, and others), formatted for easy use.